

The biotech landscape — Hong Kong & the United States

A map of the sector and where WuXi AppTec (2359.HK) sits in it. Built because "all biotech stocks" is neither obtainable nor useful — and the reason why is itself the most important thing in this document.

2026-08-07 · price and news data through 10 Aug 2026 · research and decision support, not financial advice

Read this first: this is not a complete list, and no honest one exists here. Hong Kong has **75 Chapter 18A listings** and ~77 names on a broader pharma screen. The United States has **403 companies** on an industry screen, 500+ counting related life sciences. Direct page fetching is blocked in this environment, so a complete enumeration would have meant inventing tickers.

Every name here was verified against a source. 54 securities and 5 ETFs — roughly 10% of the universe by count, far more by market capitalisation. Names that could not be verified were left out rather than guessed. Catalent was deliberately excluded: it was acquired by Novo Holdings for \$16.5bn and delisted in December 2024. **Any list still showing it is stale.**

HK UNIVERSE	US UNIVERSE	VERIFIED HERE	PHASE I → APPROVAL
75	403+	54	9.6%
Chapter 18A listings	industry screen; 500+ broader	+ 5 ETFs	BIO, 9,985 transitions

1 · "Biotech" is five different asset classes

The single most useful thing in this document. A pre-revenue Chapter 18A name and a contract research organisation are not the same investment, are not exposed to the same risks, and do not belong in the same sentence — but both get called "biotech".

SEGMENT	WHAT KILLS YOU	TIME TO FIND OUT	CAN IT GO TO ZERO?
CRO / CDMO	Customer funding cycle; POLICY and sanctions; backlog cancellation	Quarters	Very unlikely
Large-cap pharma	Patent cliff; drug pricing policy; tariffs	Years	Effectively no
Commercial-stage biotech	Product concentration; competitor entry; reimbursement	Quarters–years	Unlikely but possible
Clinical-stage / 18A	ONE trial readout; cash runway	A single morning	YES, routinely
Tools / diagnostics	Customer capex cycle; funding; China	Quarters	Very unlikely

Only one row can go to zero on a single morning, and it is the row most beginners buy — because pre-revenue names are cheap per share and have the best stories.

2 · The number to read twice

BIO analysed **9,985 phase transitions across 7,455 development programmes at 1,103 companies** and found a cumulative approval rate from Phase I of **9.6%**. Wong, Siah & Lo put it at 13.8% overall, with recent Phase I likelihood of approval as low as 6.7%. Phase II is the killing field — roughly a third survive it.

Buy one pre-revenue biotech and roughly nine times in ten the lead asset never becomes an approved drug. Selection helps but does not rescue it: rare-disease non-oncology programmes reach ~25%, biomarker-guided ~26%. That is still one in four.

The market confirms the arithmetic. At mid-2026 **nearly half of publicly traded US biotechs traded below the cash on their own balance sheets**, and **219 companies have been lost from the sector in four years**.

This is why the index route is a mathematical argument rather than a stylistic preference. 157 shots on goal captures the ~10% that work. Three hand-picked names plausibly captures zero.

3 · Hong Kong — 23 verified names

CRO / CDMO

TICKER	NAME	NOTE
2359.HK	WuXi AppTec	Largest China-based integrated CRDMO. H1 2026 revenue RMB28.90bn, +38.9% YoY
2269.HK	WuXi Biologics	Global biologics CRDMO, discovery to commercial manufacture
2268.HK	WuXi XDC	ADC / bioconjugate CRDMO; HKEX main board Nov 2023
3759.HK	Pharmaron Beijing	Lab chemistry, biology, small-molecule CDMO; dual-listed 300759.SZ
3347.HK	Hangzhou Tigermed	Clinical CRO

LARGE-CAP PHARMA

TICKER	NAME	NOTE
1177.HK	Sino Biopharmaceutical	Diversified China pharma: oncology, liver, respiratory
1093.HK	CSPC Pharmaceutical	Manufacturing and sale of pharmaceuticals
3692.HK	Hansoh Pharmaceutical	R&D through sales; Hang Seng Biotech constituent
2196.HK	Shanghai Fosun Pharma	Diversified pharma / healthcare group
1099.HK	Sinopharm Group	Pharmaceutical DISTRIBUTION — not a drug developer

COMMERCIAL-STAGE

TICKER	NAME	NOTE
6160.HK	BeOne Medicines (ex-BeiGene)	Global-scale China-origin oncology
1801.HK	Innovent Biologics	Commercial oncology / metabolic portfolio
9926.HK	Akeso	Bispecific antibody developer
9688.HK	Zai Lab	In-licensing plus internal pipeline
9995.HK	RemeGen	ADC and fusion-protein developer
6990.HK	Sichuan Kelun-Biotech	ADC-focused biopharmaceutical

CLINICAL-STAGE / PRE-REVENUE – HIGHEST RISK

TICKER	NAME	NOTE
1877.HK	Shanghai Junshi Biosciences	Antibody developer
6185.HK	CanSino Biologics	Vaccines
2171.HK	CARsgen Therapeutics	CAR-T cell therapy
2162.HK	Keymed Biosciences	Antibody / biologics
6996.HK	Antengene	Oncology, Asia-Pacific
9606.HK	DualityBio	ADC platform
2197.HK	Clover Biopharmaceuticals	Vaccines

Hong Kong also ran **12 biotech IPOs raising \$1.3bn in 2026** — **first globally by biotech IPO fundraising**. Combined biotech and healthcare market capitalisation exceeds HK\$5 trillion.

4 • United States — 31 verified names

LARGE-CAP PHARMA

TICKER	NAME	NOTE
LLY	Eli Lilly	Largest pharma by market cap, ~\$1.5tn (Feb 2026); obesity/diabetes franchise
JNJ	Johnson & Johnson	Diversified pharma + medtech, \$488.7bn
ABBV	AbbVie	Immunology-led diversified pharma, \$388.4bn
MRK	Merck & Co.	Oncology-led large pharma, ~\$262bn
PFE	Pfizer	Diversified large pharma
BMJ	Bristol-Myers Squibb	Diversified large pharma
AMGN	Amgen	Largest IBB holding at 8.42% of the fund
GILD	Gilead Sciences	Virology-led; IBB weight 7.14%

COMMERCIAL-STAGE BIOTECH

TICKER	NAME	NOTE
VRTX	Vertex Pharmaceuticals	Cystic fibrosis franchise; IBB 7.87%
REGN	Regeneron	Antibody platform; IBB 5.84%
ARGX	argenx SE	Autoimmune / FcRn; IBB 3.55%
ALNY	Alnylam	RNAi leader; first \$1bn product-revenue quarter Q1 2026
NBIX	Neurocrine Biosciences	Commercial CNS / endocrine franchise
INSM	Insmed	Rare / serious disease; XBI 1.36%
UTHR	United Therapeutics	Pulmonary arterial hypertension portfolio

TOOLS / DIAGNOSTICS

TICKER	NAME	NOTE
TMO	Thermo Fisher Scientific	Q2 2026 revenue \$11.99bn, +10%; guidance raised
DHR	Danaher	FY2026 adj. EPS guidance raised to \$8.45–8.60
ILMN	Illumina	Dominant DNA sequencing, ~\$4bn revenue
A	Agilent Technologies	~\$6.5bn analytical instruments, genomics
TWST	Twist Bioscience	Synthetic DNA; largest XBI position at 1.62%
NTRA	Natera	Molecular diagnostics; XBI 1.42%

CRO / CDMO

TICKER	NAME	NOTE
IQV	IQVIA Holdings	Largest full-service CRO; 2026 revenue outlook \$17.28–17.48bn
CRL	Charles River Laboratories	Preclinical / discovery services
MEDP	Medpace Holdings	Mid-size full-service CRO; backlog \$2.93bn at 31 Mar 2026

CLINICAL-STAGE / PRE-REVENUE – EXAMPLES ONLY, NOT RECOMMENDATIONS

Drawn from XBI's largest equal-weight positions because index membership is verifiable. **Nothing here is a view on any of them** — they illustrate what the segment looks like.

TICKER	NAME	XBI WEIGHT
APGE	Apogee Therapeutics	1.55%
ORKA	Oruka Therapeutics	1.46%
PRAX	Praxis Precision Medicines	1.42%
DNTH	Dianthus Therapeutics	1.35%
RVMD	Revolution Medicines	1.35%
SYRE	Spyre Therapeutics	1.33%

5 · The routes a retail investor can actually take

United States

TICKER	FUND	STRUCTURE – AND WHY IT MATTERS
XBI	SPDR S&P Biotech	EQUAL-weighted, 157 holdings, top-10 only 13.3%. Small/mid-cap biotech beta — far more volatile
IBB	iShares Biotechnology	CAP-weighted, 252 holdings, top-10 = 45.5%. Effectively large-cap biopharma with a long tail

Hong Kong

TICKER	FUND	NOTE
3069.HK	ChinaAMC Hang Seng HK Biotech	Explicitly includes Chapter 18A stocks. USD (9069) and RMB (83069) counters exist
3174.HK	CSOP Hang Seng Biotech	Hang Seng Biotech Index — 30 largest, Southbound-eligible, 10% cap
2820.HK	Global X China Biotech	Solactive China Biotech. Only 37 holdings — still concentrated

XBI and IBB are genuinely different bets, not two versions of the same one. XBI is equal-weighted with its top ten at 13.3% — small and mid-cap innovation, and far more volatile. IBB is cap-weighted with its top ten at 45.5% — that is a large-cap biopharma position wearing a sector label.

6 · Where 2359.HK sits — and the one thing that decides it

WuXi AppTec is a **CRDMO**, not a drug developer. Contracted revenue, no binary trial risk. Operationally it is performing exceptionally: H1 2026 revenue **RMB28.90bn, +38.9% YoY**, gross margin +9.4pp, backlog +25.2%, full-year guidance raised to RMB58.5–60.5bn. It has also *actually* divested its US/UK cell-therapy unit to Altaris and has a Delaware site starting up in Q4 2026 — action, not announcement. In the first half of 2026 it out-earned Lonza for the first time (US\$4.28bn vs US\$4.17bn): it is now the largest firm in its category, not the challenger.

What the price has already done

Six sessions, +25%, to an all-time high. Anything written on a stale quote is wrong by a wide margin, so the prices are dated individually. Closes, except 10 August, which is intraday.

DATE	2359.HK	603259.SS	EVENT
3 Aug	HK\$162.90	RMB128.50	H1 2026 results released
4 Aug	HK\$181.10 +11.2%	RMB141.35 +10.0%	Results reaction; A limit-up, H intraday +14%
7 Aug	HK\$192.30	RMB154.82	CICC target → HK\$211; Jefferies → HK\$210
10 Aug	HK\$204.20	RMB166.66	All-time high, intraday — injunction announced to market 9 Aug evening

Year to date the H line is **+97%** against the A line's **+73.5%** (7 Aug basis). The 52-week low was HK\$96.70 — the stock has roughly doubled.

The Hong Kong line is the expensive one. WuXi is one of a small set of Chinese "hard tech" names where the usual A-share premium has **inverted**: the H shares traded at a **~5% premium to the A shares** on 10 August (~10% on 4 August, >4% back in April). Buying 2359.HK rather than 603259.SS means paying up. The honest reasons to do it anyway are account access, Stock Connect flow and index membership — not value.

Two number traps in the public coverage. Vendor market-cap fields for this dual-listed name span **HK\$440bn to HK\$609bn** — a 35% spread — because some count the H float only; the ~HK\$600bn figure is the one consistent with the current price and the share count. And several English summaries rendered 288.97億元 as "RMB 289bn": the correct first-half revenue is **RMB28.897bn**, ten times smaller.

But read what the growth actually is. Chemistry is ~86.5% of revenue and grew +53.3%; Biology grew +11.2%, roughly flat in real terms. Inside Chemistry, TIDES — oligonucleotides and peptides — is RMB7.26bn, +44.3%, and WuXi is reported to hold about a quarter of the global clinical-stage GLP-1 market across 24 programmes. Three concentrations sit on top of each other: one segment, one drug class, one country of customer. That is a diversified-CRDMO label on a GLP-1 manufacturing business, and Chinese CDMOs are adding peptide capacity fast.

The policy timeline, stated precisely

Most coverage blurs "introduced", "passed", "enacted" and "in force". Those distinctions decide the whole case.

DATE	WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED
2023–24	BIOSECURE introduced, naming WuXi AppTec and WuXi Biologics in the bill text
Sep 2024	Passed the House only — then died with the 118th Congress
9 Oct 2025	Re-introduced; Senate passed it as an FY2026 NDAA amendment
18 Dec 2025	ENACTED. But the enacted text does not name WuXi — it defines a "biotechnology company of concern" by reference to lists, and WuXi was on none of them. A genuine reprieve.
8 Jun 2026	Reprieve ends — Dept of War adds WuXi AppTec to the Section 1260H list of Chinese military companies
7 Aug 2026	Chief Judge Boasberg (D.D.C.) preliminarily ENJOINS the designation , finding it likely arbitrary and capricious and that officials "repeatedly misread the evidence." Case 1:26-cv-02069. The court then refused the Pentagon a stay pending appeal and set WuXi's bond at US\$1 — an appeal is therefore signalled, though no notice of appeal was verified.
18 Dec 2026	OMB's initial list is due. Four months out, and the nearest real event.
~late 2028	Earliest date prohibitions actually bite: OMB guidance +180 days → FAR rule +1 year → +60 days

Three facts that cut in WuXi's favour, and are widely missed. The scope is **federal procurement, grant and loan nexus only** — private pharma with no federal contract is not barred from using WuXi. Grandfathering runs **five years**, and the carve-out that would deny it applies only to firms listed as of 18 Dec 2025 — WuXi was added later, so **its existing contracts qualify**. And nothing is in force today.

Anyone calling this "uninvestable China risk" has not read the statute.

And the fact that decides it anyway. Boasberg's own irreparable-harm finding records that customers **had already cancelled contracts and moved business to competitors within eight weeks of the listing — before any prohibition was operative.**

The market punishes the label, not the effective date. That is why "nothing bites until 2028" is false comfort. Aggregate growth of +38.9% will mask new-award diversion for several reporting periods before it shows in the headline.

And the half-year the market just bought cannot contain it. The designation was live for roughly three weeks of a six-month reporting period (8–30 June). The cancellations a federal judge found as fact land in **second-half 2026**. Watch the **RMB66.43bn backlog** rather than revenue — cancelled work leaves the backlog first. Named customers and contract values were not disclosed.

Roughly **60–68% of revenue is US** — the range is honest; the sources do not reconcile to a point estimate. Growth engine and political risk are the same jurisdiction, so the company cannot hedge it internally. **Verdict: LIVE, not resolved.** The injunction is interim and appealable, and policy pressure is still increasing.

Read-across — where the same risk sits without the same protection

WuXi Biologics (2269.HK) and WuXi XDC (2268.HK) are NOT on the 1260H list — but both were named in a December 2025 congressional letter. Same targeting, **none of the legal protection WuXi AppTec has just won.** The next 1260H cycle is June 2027 and is not priced.

Capacity beneficiaries if Chinese CROs are restricted: **Samsung Biologics, Lonza, Charles River (CRL), Fujifilm Diosynth** — all capacity-constrained with two-to-five-year lead times.

On timing, honestly: on the injunction we are *behind* the market, not ahead of it. The stock re-rated 25% in six sessions to an all-time high, and the consensus average 12-month target of **HK\$183.46** now sits *below* spot — any screen reading "trades below target" is broken on this name today. Whatever edge remains sits in the **OMB list on 18 December 2026**, the **appellate ruling**, and the **June 2027 1260H cycle for 2269 and 2268** — none of which appears priced.

7 • What this document does not know

Every external domain was blocked (HTTP 403) — `hsi.com.hk` and `chinaamc.com.hk` among them — so a complete Hang Seng Biotech 30-name constituent list remains open. **WuXi's US revenue share reconciles only to a 60–68% range, not a point estimate**, and the 2026 first-half split by geography could not be obtained at all — the ~70% US figure is a full-year 2025 disclosure reaching us through secondary media, not a filing anyone here read. No court docket was opened either, so the ruling date is reported as "on or about 7–8 August" and the Pentagon's appeal is inferred from its refused stay motion rather than from a filed notice — the highest-value open question on this name. **ICON plc** is the second-largest full-service CRO by revenue (\$8,251.3m FY2025) but is named without a ticker because none was verified against a market-data source. Asymchem, Everest Medicines and the Novo Nordisk ADR were omitted for the same reason. Nothing was guessed to fill a gap.

Research and decision support — not financial advice. No name in this document is a recommendation. Clinical-stage names in particular are listed to illustrate a risk category, and the base rate in section 2 applies to all of them.

Compiled by Elon Musk, Industry Research (Dept 1), with section 6 policy work by The dictator (Regulatory, Dept 4) and price, results and A/H analysis by 修大哥 (Global News, Dept 4). 皮樓黃 Capital, 2026-08-07; prices through 10 Aug 2026. Full sourced reports with citations: `reports/industry/2026-08-07-biotech-landscape.md`, `reports/news/2026-08-07-2359hk-regulatory.md`, `reports/news/2026-08-07-2359hk-news.md`. Universe counts: HKEX Group Insight 2026; ChartMill US industry screen; XBI/IBB holdings via stockanalysis.com, Aug 2026.